

Business Mission Analysis: OpenAI

Strategic Management (full-time form)

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Mission Statement

Our mission is to ensure that artificial general intelligence benefits all of humanity. (OpenAI, 2026).

Evaluation of the Formulation

The mission is evaluated using the following four conditions:

1. Market Orientation

OpenAI's mission focuses on bringing benefits to people. This is a strength because it gives the company a purpose beyond just developing technology or selling products.

However, it does not explain which needs the company wants to satisfy. *All of humanity* is very broad and does not identify any particular customers or markets. The statement tells us what technology OpenAI works on, but little about what people should gain from it.

Assessment: partly met

2. Realisticity (Possibility to Realise)

Main problem is the word *ensure*. OpenAI can influence how they develop their technology, but they cannot fully control how others use it. Making sure that it benefits everyone is therefore a very difficult promise to fulfil. Great example might be a misuse for malicious purposes.

There is also no clear way to decide when the mission has been achieved. What counts as a benefit, and does it have to reach every person? The mission makes sense as a long-term ambition, but it is hard to treat it as an achievable goal.

Assessment: weakly met

3. Motivation

This is probably the strongest part of the mission. Working on something that could help people gives employees a reason to care about their work beyond their salary. The statement is also short and easy to remember.

On the other hand, the idea of benefiting humanity is still quite abstract. It does not tell employees much about how to make everyday decisions, especially when helping one group could create problems for another one.

Assessment: partly met

4. Specificity (Specification)

The reference to artificial general intelligence gives the mission a clear field. It is more specific than simply saying that the company wants to make the world better.

Though, it does not explain what makes OpenAI different from other AI companies. It says nothing about its main users, products or approach. Another company working on AGI could use almost the same mission.

Assessment: partly met

Overall assessment

The mission is short and motivating, but too broad to give much guidance for business decisions. It identifies the field OpenAI works in and the outcome it wants. It does not explain which needs it serves or how success should be measured.

The biggest weakness is the promise to *ensure* benefits for everyone. I would keep the ambition, but make the wording more concrete and less absolute.

Proposal of adjustments

My proposed version:

We develop AI tools that help people learn, work and solve problems. We aim to make these tools useful, safe and accessible, while working towards artificial general intelligence whose benefits are widely shared.

This version names the needs the company wants to serve and connects them to its work. It also keeps the original ambition without promising an outcome that one company cannot fully control. More detailed goals would still be needed to measure an actual progress.

Sources

- [OpenAI, 2026] OpenAI. 2026 About | OpenAI. [online]. [cit. 2026-10-05]. Available from: <https://openai.com/about/>.